

Israel, Hamas agree to ceasefire deal

Biden and Trump compete for credit after teams' cooperation

BY HANNAH KNOWLES, TOLUSE OLORUNNIPA AND KAREN DEYOUNG

President Joe Biden and President-elect Donald Trump jockeyed Wednesday for credit for a ceasefire and hostage-release deal between Hamas and Israel that Biden had long pursued and that came together days before Trump is set to retake the White House.

The Biden and Trump teams worked closely in the days leading up to the deal, talking daily and holding meetings in Qatar and Israel. Biden officials said a meeting Saturday between Trump's incoming Middle East envoy, Steve Witkoff, and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was crucial to closing the deal, and Witkoff has called the Biden administration "the tip of the spear" in talks.

Their cooperation represents a highly unusual moment in the polarized world of U.S. politics, especially given the contentious history between the president and president-elect. But it did not stop both Trump and Biden from touting their respective roles.

Trump declared on social media that "the EPIC ceasefire agreement could have only happened as a result of our Historic Victory in November." The president-elect, SEE NEGOTIATIONS ON A14



HEIDI LEVINE FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Relatives and friends of people killed and abducted by Hamas react to the ceasefire announcement Wednesday in Tel Aviv. The truce would begin Sunday and cover an initial period of 42 days. Mediators hope it will then evolve into a three-stage process for lasting peace.

Hostages' families: Relatives of those held in Gaza are grappling with both relief and fear amid the news of a ceasefire and release agreement. A14

HOPES FOR REPRIEVE IN 15-MONTH WAR

First phase calls for release of 33 hostages

This article is by Claire Parker, Karen DeYoung, Gerry Shih, Hazem Balousha and Heba Farouk Mahfouz

JERUSALEM — After more than a year of painstaking negotiations, Israel and Hamas agreed Wednesday to a ceasefire deal in the Gaza Strip that, if implemented, would see nearly three dozen Israeli hostages reunited with their families and give hungry and displaced Palestinians a reprieve from months of violence.

Israel's government still needs to formally approve the deal, in a vote officials say will take place Thursday morning. But the agreement could mark a first step toward ending a 15-month war that has destroyed Gaza and divided Israelis.

The truce, mediated by the United States, Egypt and Qatar, would begin on Sunday and cover an initial period of 42 days.

"This is one of the toughest negotiations I've ever experienced," President Joe Biden said Wednesday in remarks from the White House. "And I'm deeply satisfied this day has come ... for the sake of the people of Israel and the families waiting in agony, and for SEE CEASEFIRE ON A13

Trump weighs executive action to 'save TikTok'

Delayed enforcement of ban-or-sale law may buy time to hammer out deal

BY DREW HARWELL AND ELIZABETH DWOSKIN

President-elect Donald Trump is considering an executive order once in office that would suspend enforcement of the TikTok ban-or-sale law for 60 to 90 days, buying the administration time to negotiate a sale or alternative solution — a legally questionable effort to win a brief reprieve for the Chinese-owned app now scheduled to be banned on Sunday nationwide.

Trump has been mulling ways to save the day for the wildly popular video app, talking through unconventional deal-making and legal maneuvers such as an executive order that would unravel the law passed by Congress last year with bipartisan support, according to two people familiar with the deliberations, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss private talks.

Trump has expressed a keen interest in being seen as rescuing a platform on which he's been told he's widely admired, leading political aides and business allies to scramble for options that would allow him to deliver on his campaign promise to "save TikTok," as he has said repeatedly on SEE TIKTOK ON A2

Biden warns of 'oligarchy' in a somber farewell

Oval Office speech caps a 50-year career that saw tragedy and triumph

BY TOLUSE OLORUNNIPA AND CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR.

President Joe Biden used his final address from the Oval Office to deliver a somber warning about the threat posed by the "dangerous concentration of power" in the hands of wealthy and well-connected individuals, a thinly veiled reference to billionaire technology executives who have been increasingly signaling their desire to work closely with President-elect Donald Trump.

"Today, an oligarchy is taking shape in America of extreme



MANDEL NGAN/POOL/EPA-EFE/SHUTTERSTOCK

President Joe Biden delivers his farewell address to the nation Wednesday night, in which he decried a "tech-industrial complex."

wealth, power and influence that literally threatens our entire democracy, our basic rights and freedoms, and a fair shot for everyone to get ahead," Biden said during his farewell speech, days before he steps down from a four-year presidency and a lifetime in public office. "We see the consequences all across America, and we've seen it before."

Biden likened the current crop of tech moguls to the "robber barons" of the 19th century, men like John D. Rockefeller and Andrew Carnegie. Recalling President Dwight D. Eisenhower's farewell address warning about the military-industrial complex, Biden decried a "tech-industrial complex that could pose real dangers to our country."

The stark comparisons underscored how a president who has often heralded the "possibilities" SEE BIDEN ON A6

Among L.A. service workers, dreams turn to ashes

BY DAN ROSENZWEIG-ZIFF

PASADENA, CALIF. — Nadia Martinez, a janitor, lost the Altadena home she's rented for 15 months and everything inside, including beloved photos of her late mother and her children still in Honduras. Her husband, Saul Moreno, a gardener, lost his lawn mower, leaf blower and other equipment that made his livelihood possible.

On the rolls of victims of the region's devastating fires, alongside wealthy and well-connected residents, are thousands of service workers like Martinez and Moreno whose jobs in landscaping, cleaning and contracting, jobs that make the metropolis run, vanished in last week's fires.

Many have clients whose homes are destroyed or inaccessible, meaning a sudden and dramatic loss of income. Some are too traumatized to work. Many have also lost their homes.

SEE SERVICE WORKERS ON A9



JOEL ANGEL JUAREZ FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Volunteers gather at the Pasadena Community Job Center, usually a spot for day laborers to find work.

'It's like a prison': Shifting rules at a barricade frustrate residents. A8

Ex-clergyman's career thrived despite claims of sexual abuse

FBI now investigating accusations by boys against youth minister of Falls Church Episcopal in 1990s

BY IAN SHAPIRA

One weekend in early 1991, Jeff Taylor, the youth minister at a centuries-old church catering to Washington's elite, invited a boy in his congregation to a religious retreat in Illinois. The 13-year-old from the Falls Church Episcopal in Northern Virginia felt flattered, he later recalled. He said he had admired Taylor, a married man with children, even if Taylor bothered him with questions about how often or whether he masturbated.

On their last night, the man said, he and Taylor stayed at someone's home in suburban Chicago. Somehow, he said, the pair wound up sharing a bed. Then, Taylor — who years later would lead a Red Cross chapter in Georgia and a fundraising arm at the University of Cincinnati

Foundation — fondled the middle-schooler with lotion in the middle of the night, the church youth group alumnus recalled.

"He kept saying, 'You seem stressed out, you seem anxious,'" said the youth group alumnus, now a partner at a financial firm in his 40s, who is speaking for the first time with a news organization about his allegations. "I recall feeling shame. The next morning, Jeff said, 'Did you feel that, too? This was an evil room, and we need to pray about this room.'"

The alumnus was one of three Falls Church Episcopal youth group members who an independent investigation revealed in April were allegedly sexually abused by Taylor in the 1990s or the early 2000s when they SEE ABUSE ON A10

IN THE NEWS

Inflation picks up The consumer price index rose 2.9 percent in December year over year, but "core" prices showed hopeful signs. A20

Maryland budget Gov. Wes Moore's proposal would raise taxes for the state's wealthiest earners but reduce them for most in the face of a \$3 billion deficit. B1

THE NATION Pam Bondi was evasive on prosecuting Trump's foes at her hearing for attorney general. A4
A watchdog says that Defense Secretary Lloyd Austin violated protocol during an illness. A6

THE WORLD South African police pulled 60 bodies from a mine where people were likely still trapped. A12
Questions and answers about the detainment of South Korea's impeached president. A13

THE ECONOMY Elon Musk was sued by the SEC over when he disclosed his purchase of Twitter shares before buying the site. A15
In a late move on tobacco policy, the Biden administration released a proposal to dramatically lower nicotine levels in cigarettes. A16

THE REGION A man who died in a shootout with D.C. police was an Army veteran who had PTSD, his mother said. B1
Richmond replaced its utility director as Virginia Gov. Glenn Youngkin and the city's mayor look into a days-long water outage. B1

STYLE First lady Jill Biden prepares to leave the White House, reflecting on the past year — and looking to the future. C1
LOCAL LIVING Learn to shop smarter in a world where finding reliable product recommendations online is harder than ever.

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